Karthikeyan Ramakrishnan

Director, FMCG and Grocery

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PROFILE

Heads the FMCG and Grocery vertical at Ninjacart: P&L, category strategy, pricing and the seller and buyer apps. Previously led revenue and growth at Unacademy: 30% YoY revenue growth at 20% EBITDA with positive cash flow. Built core backend functions from scratch at Fashinza and launched Valarlife, a D2C online store. 10+ years; led cross-functional teams of over 250 members.

- E-commerce P&L and growth levers: managed P&L for a $5M portfolio at 20% EBITDA at Unacademy; worked levers across acquisition (Performance Marketing, >10X ROI), conversion, retention (CLM), assortment
- Category, SKU and whitespace: category strategy, product selection and pricing at Ninjacart; daily price benchmarking across 75+ SKUs in 30+ cities; used market research to identify whitespace (untapped opportunities) and
- Customer journey and data-driven decisions: product managed Ninjacart's seller and buyer apps; Unacademy funnel strategy from discovery to conversion; CLM campaigns for engagement, retention and stickiness; SQL, Tableau, Amplitude, Google
- Operating model, D2C and ownership: built core backend functions from scratch at Fashinza (monthly GMV to $100K in a year); 5x daily volume growth in 100 days at Ninjacart; launched

EXPERIENCE

Director, FMCG and Grocery

Aug'24 – Present

Ninjacart

- Own end-to-end P&L management for the FMCG and Grocery vertical, including pricing strategies and inventory optimization
- Own category strategy: end-to-end category management, product selection and retail strategy implementation
- Run market intelligence and vendor negotiations behind pricing and product selection
- Product managed the entire development and deployment of the seller and buyer facing applications, working closely with the tech and engineering teams

Associate Director, Growth & Revenue

Feb'22 – Jan'24

Unacademy

- Managed P&L for a $5M portfolio at 20% EBITDA; attained 30% YoY revenue growth with 20% EBITDA and positive cash flow
- Drove online revenue market share from 8% to 55% in 18 months
- Delivered >10X ROI on Performance Marketing campaigns: $1.3M in revenue against $100K spend
- Devised content strategies for top-of-funnel (Performance Marketing and GTMs), mid-funnel (product interaction) and bottom-funnel (conversion), covering acquisition, conversion and retention levers
- Optimized Customer Lifecycle Management (CLM) campaigns to improve engagement, retention and user stickiness
- Used market research to identify whitespace (untapped opportunities) and threats, adjusting strategies accordingly

Senior Manager, Category Management and Operations

Mar'21 – Feb'22

Fashinza (Tirupur)

- Scaled monthly GMV to $100K within a year, setting up core backend functions from scratch
- Established a network of 500+ suppliers and managed the entire base for sourcing
- Led the development of product assortments aligned with customer preferences and market demand
- Collaborated with engineering and design teams to support product launches

Senior Manager, Category Management

Apr'18 – Mar'21

Ninjacart (Chennai)

- Managed P&L for key categories contributing 60% of revenue
- Drove 5x growth in daily volumes within 100 days
- Led data-driven P&L optimization and market intelligence for 30+ cities, with daily price benchmarking across 75+ SKUs

Software Engineer

Sep'14 – Aug'17

Accenture (Chennai)

- Led the end-to-end software development lifecycle, including design and implementation of business-critical applications, while analyzing key performance drivers
- Managed incident resolution through multiple channels and integrated new technologies and automation to improve existing systems

SKILLS

P&L Optimization | Category Management | Revenue Growth Strategies | Customer Lifecycle Management | Performance Marketing | ROI Optimization | Market Intelligence | Market Trend Analysis | Supply Chain Optimization | Procurement and Fulfillment | Operations Scaling | Business Process Re-engineering | SQL | Tableau

ENTREPRENEURIAL VENTURES

- Valarlife: launched a D2C online store for spirulina and moringa health supplements; revenue generated $200 K, funding $100 K
- Fraternitee: B2B apparel manufacturing for schools, colleges, startups, corporates and NGOs; revenue generated $250 K
- Dazzilo: conceptualized and developed an AI powered influencer marketing platform; secured three term sheets, did not proceed due to unfavorable terms
- Livepurse: pitched a fintech platform for micro and fractional investing to marquee VCs; MVP ready, launch hindered by SEBI regulations

LANGUAGES KNOWN

- English, Hindi, Tamil, Kannada & Telugu

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science

2014

CEG, Anna University